

- Denim jacket
- Leather jacket
- Lace-hemmed slip, which looks equally chic under a leather or a dinner jacket
- Camel coat
- Two pairs of jeans: one dark, one light. One of them can be distressed, but have another for days when the 'clean' look is called for, like Fridays in the office.
- A blazer dress that doubles as a frock
- A long-line open or closed jacket
- A black, a navy and a plum tailored dress
- A handful of white, black and grey T-shirts
- Black boots, nude heels, black heels, nude flats, black flats.

Buy Kmart if it suits, or Maticovski if you have the means. Your budget limit is your own.

Speaking of Kmart, the clothing rack I bought cost \$29 from the discount giant. If I washed one of the above everyday pieces, it went back on the rack, not in the closet. By having your daily clothes on display, as a mini-wardrobe, you can get the full value out of those purchases, and it becomes clearer what you *really* need to top up on or are lacking. Turf out as much of the rest as you can; I quickly accepted I didn't need 80 per cent of what I owned. That helped me cull and sell from the main wardrobe, as its contents increasingly languished over weeks and months.

As I mentioned in the introduction, my own spending frenzy started when I was a fashion editor and I was too red-faced to admit to Carla Zampatti, the iconic Australian womenswear designer, that I was wearing a \$20 frock to a high-profile Sydney fashion parade. After Zampatti, one the first fashion designers I met was Perth-based Aurelio Costarella. After 34 years dressing celebrities of the calibre of Cate Blanchett, Rihanna and Princess Mary of Denmark, with his designs adorning David Jones stores nationally, he retired from the couture caper.

Costarella has been very open about the toll the fashion industry took on him. As he embarks on a new chapter of his life, he has passionately emphasised that a designer suit is not, and should never be, a cure for poor self-esteem. For all the reams of silk thread and fine fabric Costarella can